

Serie 21

DIAGONALIZABILITY, CAYLEY-HAMILTON

1. Let K be a field. Let $p(X) \in K[X]$ be a polynomial. Let $A, Q \in M_{n \times n}(K)$ be matrices such that Q is invertible. Show that

$$p(Q^{-1}AQ) = Q^{-1}p(A)Q$$

2. For $k \in \mathbb{N}$, let $p_k(X) = \sum_{i=0}^d c_i^{(k)} X^i$, $p(X) = \sum_{i=0}^d c_i X^i \in \mathbb{C}[X]$ be polynomials such that $\deg(p_k) \leq d$ for some fixed positive integer d . We say that p_k converges to p , as $k \rightarrow \infty$ if

$$c_d^{(k)} X^d + c_{d-1}^{(k)} X^{d-1} + \dots + c_0^{(k)}$$

converges to $c_d X^d + c_{d-1} X^{d-1} + \dots + c_0$ as $k \rightarrow \infty$. If $A, A_k \in M_{n \times n}(\mathbb{C})$ are matrices such that $A_k \rightarrow A$ as $k \rightarrow \infty$ and p_k converges to p , then show

$$p_k(A_k) \rightarrow p(A)$$

as $k \rightarrow \infty$.

3. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ and $A = (a_{ij})_{i,j} \in M_{n \times n}(\mathbb{C})$. Show that there exists a matrix $B = (b_{ij})_{i,j} \in M_{n \times n}(\mathbb{C})$ which is upper diagonalisable, such that $|b_{ij} - a_{ij}| < \varepsilon$.
4. Using the exercises above, prove the Cayley-Hamilton theorem.

Hint: First show it for diagonal matrices, then use Exercise 1 to show it for diagonalisable matrices).